August 25th, 2026

Housing Affordability Working Group (HAWG)

We begin this meeting by acknowledging that we are on the unceded and unconquered territory of the Algonquin Anishinaabe people.

We are grateful for this opportunity and we thank all the generations of Indigenous peoples who have taken care of and continue to take care of this land since time immemorial.

CCA Charter of Respect

The Centretown Community Association is committed to providing a professional, friendly, safe and welcoming environment for all participants at its meeting and events, regardless of gender, sexual orientation, disability, skin colour, ethnicity, religion, national origin, economic situation, age or language.

We expect all participants and speakers at CCA meetings and events to help ensure a safe and positive experience for everyone both in conversation and in the chat room by treating each other with dignity and respect.

This requirement for respect at all times applies to all communication forums including phone and email.

Today's agenda

Defining Renovictions

Renovictions vs Rent Control

Case Study: Ottawa

Case Study: Hamilton

Case Study: London

Case Study: Toronto

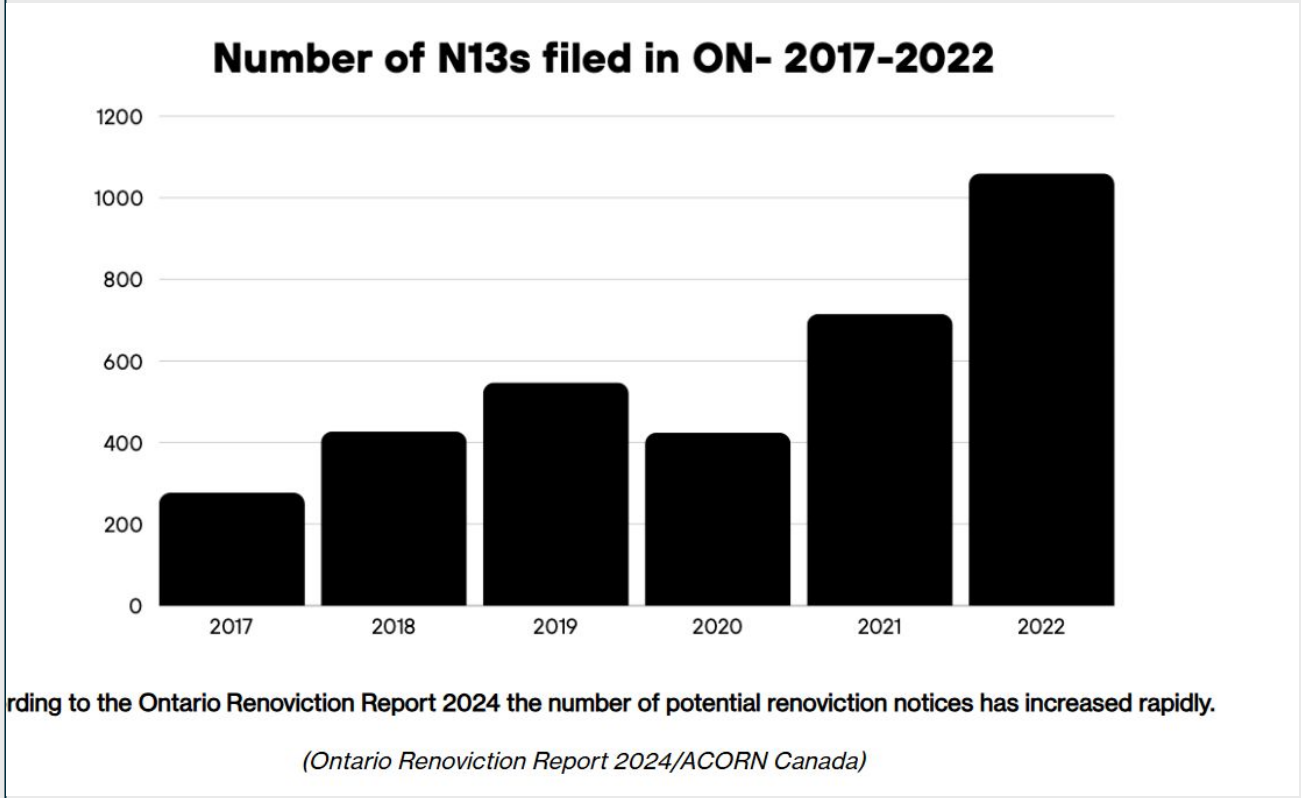
Defining Renovictions

- A landlord must present an N13 notice to tenants informing them that their tenancy is ending because the landlord wants to renovate, demolish, or convert the unit
- A renoviction occurs when a landlord evicts a tenant to repair or renovate a rental unit, often with the intent of re-listing the unit at a higher rate.
- Renovictions do not always happen in good faith. Some landlords may fail to issue an N13 notice, they might pressure or intimidate a tenant to leave, or they may re-list the unit after minimal renovations at a significantly higher rate.
- This can result in displaced tenants being forced into a rental market they can't afford and the progressive loss of affordable housing protected by rent control.

Sources:

Ottawa renoviction bylaw that satisfies neither landlords nor tenants passes committee | CBC News
What is a renoviction? - Alliance to End Homelessness Ottawa

N13's issued in Ontario increased from 2017 to 2022



rding to the Ontario Renoviction Report 2024 the number of potential renoviction notices has increased rapidly.

(Ontario Renoviction Report 2024/ACORN Canada)

- Close to a 300% increase in N13's in Ontario from 2017 to 2022.
- According to a tenant-rights association, ACORN, this figure may be understating the number of renovictions due to practices like "cash for keys."

Sources: ACORN, Ontario Renoviction Report

Renovictions vs Rent Control

- Important to distinguish between *tenant protection policies* such as bylaws prohibiting renovictions and *rent control* (where the price of rent is capped by the provincial government).
- Policymakers debate the pros and cons of rent control.
- Rent control protects low-income tenants against displacement.
- Critics of rent control argue it can negatively affect the supply of rental units by discouraging the construction of new units, or disincentivize adequate maintenance of units (thus allowing units to more units to fall into disrepair).
- Some academic research argues that rental protection policies (including prohibitions on renovictions) are more effective at protecting the vulnerable without affecting supply.
- Some landlords argue that renoviction policies may force smaller landlords out of the market (in favour of large companies like Real Estate Investment Trusts) or discourage investment in new construction.

Sources:

CMHC, Accelerating Rental Supply
CMHC, Rent Control and Affordability
Do rent controls and other tenancy regulations affect new construction?
Toronto's Renoviction Crackdown

Renoviction Case Studies: Ottawa

- Addressing the issue of renovictions will need to be a part of a larger strategy to tackle homelessness and affordability issues in Ottawa.
- Rental units account for 36% of households in Ottawa (this may increase to 43% by 2035) yet account for 75% of all households that are in core housing need.
- Tenants who are victim of renoviction can end up in emergency shelters.
- New bylaw passed by the City of Ottawa in July and to take effect January 1st, 2027, "Rental Renovation Licence Bylaw."
- Landlords will be required to apply to the city for a permit within a week of issuing an N13 to tenants.
- Updates to the policy may follow as the City of Ottawa considers aligning it with practices in other cities including:
    - Providing accommodations for displaced tenants
    - Ensure a qualified person (such as an engineer or architect) confirms the renovations are necessary

Sources:

CBC, Ottawa Renoviction Bylaw
Statistics Canada, Core Housing Need of a Private Household
Statistics Canada, Census 2021, author's own calculations
Planning and Housing Committee, Rental Renovation Bylaw Review
ACORN. https://acorncanada.org/news/we-did-it-ottawa-finally-has-a-renoviction-bylaw/

"Core Housing Need" refers to a household that falls below at least one of the indicator thresholds for housing adequacy, affordability or suitability, and would have to spend 30% or more of its total before-tax income to pay the median rent of alternative local housing that is acceptable

Renoviction Case Studies: Toronto

- Toronto City Council passed the Rental Renovation Licence Bylaw to deter bad faith renovictions, in July 2025.
- Landlords must apply for a permit to evict their tenant for reno purposes within 7 days of notifying the tenant of the planned eviction.
- Cost to apply for a permit $728 as of 2026.
- Permit requires proof from an architect or engineer that repairs are needed.
- Landlords must also pay for moving expenses for the tenant.
- Tenant-advocacy organizations report seeing a drop in the number of calls related to renovictions, and argue this demonstrates the policy has been successful.

Sources:
The Toronto Star: Toronto`s Renoviction Bylaw Took Effect a Year Ago

Renoviction Case Studies: Hamilton

- Hamilton's Renovation Licence and Relocation By-law came into effect on January 1, 2025.
- Landlords must apply for a Renovation Licence when they serve an N13 eviction notice for extensive renovations.
- When a tenant receives an N13 notice and chooses to return to their unit post-renovations, the landlord must:
    - Make temporary arrangements for the tenant that are comparable in cost, location and size or provide compensation if comparable housing is not available
    - Allow their tenant to return to their renovated unit at the same rate
- Hamilton saw a 983% increase in the number of renoviction notices issued to tenants between 2017-2022.
- N13 eviction notices dropped in Hamilton from 119 in 2024 to 23 in 2025. Proposed amendments include introducing mandatory moving supports for displaced tenants (up to $2,500).
- Critics note the compliance-based enforcement model puts too much responsibility on tenants.

Sources:

Renovation Licence and Relocation By-law | City of Hamilton , Hamilton to become 1st Ontario city with bylaw to stop 'bad faith' renovictions | CBC News , Hamilton moves to strengthen renoviction bylaw with 1 year of data, renter feedback | CBC News

Renoviction Case Studies: London

- London approved a Rental Unit Repair Licence under its Business Licencing By-law in March 2025.
- The licence requires landlords to:
  - Obtain a building permit for the renovation or repair of the rental unit
  - Obtain a report from a qualified professional stating that renovations require the unit to be vacant
  - Apply for a Rental Unit Repair Licence within 7 days of giving an N13 notice to a tenant
  - Provide the tenant with a copy of a Tenant Information Package
- Critics noted that landlords aren't required to provide alternate accommodations or to top-up rent for the displaced tenant. Additionally, the bylaw can be difficult to enforce when those acting in bad faith don't apply for a licence.
- Proposed amendments include a more robust Tenant Information Package and a sworn affidavit from landlords to ensure compliance.
- ACORN London is advocating for protection when affordable housing is demolished, including:
  - Replacement of affordable units in new development and replacement units offered to displaced tenants
  - Temporary accommodations or rental top ups provided for affected tenants, including moving costs

Sources:

Council approves Renoviction Bylaw changes to support tenants' rights | City of London Ontario city approves new 'renoviction' bylaw some critics call 'weak' | Globalnews.ca Loopholes in the Renoviction Bylaw? Preventing Unnecessary Loss of Affordable Housing - London Council Watch London Takes Steps to Stop Demovictions! - ACORN Canada Tenants group says one year in, London's renoviction bylaw is working | CBC News

Comparison across cities

Table 2. An overview of Ontario by-laws to deter bad faith evictions for renovations or repairs.

	Hamilton	London	Toronto	Waterloo	Mississauga	Kitchener
Rental renovation licence	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Building permit	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Qualified persons report	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Education guide	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Alternate unit or additional compensa-tion	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Moving allowance	Yes (2026 update)	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Severance compensa-tion	No	No	Yes	No	No	No

Sources:
https://pub-ottawa.escribemeetings.com/filestream.ashx?DocumentId=327252

Discussion Questions

1. Does the City of Ottawa's new bylaw go far enough? Not far enough?
2. Have you or someone you know been personally affected by a renoviction?
3. What else should municipalities be doing to balance the rights of tenants and landlords?
4. What would you like to see the Centretown Community Association do to raise awareness of this issue?

Sources:

Council approves Renoviction Bylaw changes to support tenants' rights | City of London Ontario city approves new 'renoviction' bylaw some critics call 'weak' | Globalnews.ca Loopholes in the Renoviction Bylaw? Preventing Unnecessary Loss of Affordable Housing - London Council Watch London Takes Steps to Stop Demovictions! - ACORN Canada Tenants group says one year in, London's renoviction bylaw is working | CBC News